THE CLAUDE ADVANTAGE

Framework Flash Cards

10 proprietary frameworks · print and keep at your desk

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The Prompting Hierarchy

Five levels of Claude fluency — each one unlocking qualitatively different output

	Name / Stage / Step	What it means in practice
1	**The Requestor — Asks for things**	Single, self-contained requests. No context, no iteration. Accepts output as-is or rewrites from scratch. Uses Claude like a search engine.
2	**The Instructor — Gives specific instructions**	Adds constraints, format, and tone. Knows that 'formal email' differs from 'casual email.' Still thinking in single prompts rather than ongoing collaboration.
3	**The Collaborator — Builds on outputs iteratively**	Uses the conversation across multiple rounds. Reviews output diagnostically — not just 'is it good enough' but 'what specifically is missing.' Where most self-described advanced users actually operate.
4	**The System Designer — Creates reusable systems**	Pre-loaded Projects, personal prompt libraries, designed prompt chains. Deploys a system rather than building from scratch every session. Output quality consistently exceeds what most think is achievable.
5	**The Architect — Designs workflows for the organisation**	Encodes team expertise, creates shared prompt libraries, builds AI-powered processes across functions. Output quality improves organisation-wide, not just personally.

WHEN TO USE When starting any new type of task — ask yourself which level you are currently operating at, and what one thing would move you up.

REMEMBER Most professionals who consider themselves advanced users are operating at Level 3. The gap to Level 4 is a Project and a prompt library — not a skill gap.

The PUSH Method

Iterative refinement as a professional skill — from close draft to excellent final output

	Name / Stage / Step	What it means in practice
P	**Probe the output**	Read the first response diagnostically. What's strong? What's missing? What's slightly off in tone, structure, or specificity? Don't simply ask 'is it good enough' — ask 'what specifically is wrong.'
U	**Understand what's missing**	Name the gap precisely before writing your next prompt. Vague dissatisfaction produces vague improvement. Specific diagnosis — 'the second paragraph is too generic and doesn't reference the client's situation' — produces specific improvement.
S	**Sharpen your instruction**	Write a follow-up prompt that addresses exactly what's missing. Be explicit: 'Make the second paragraph more specific — mention the data migration issue and reassure her the core deliverable is unaffected. Remove the overly apologetic opening.'
H	**Harvest the improvement**	Review the refined output. Extract what works. Either accept it or run another PUSH cycle. Most professional tasks reach excellent quality in two to three cycles. If you're on cycle four, the problem is the brief — not the prompting.

WHEN TO USE After any first draft that is close but not right. Run at least two PUSH cycles before accepting or discarding any output.

REMEMBER The difference between Level 2 and Level 3 is not prompt quality — it is whether you iterate. PUSH makes that iteration deliberate rather than accidental.

The Context Stack

Three documents loaded once into a Claude Project — and every session inherits them automatically

Document 1 — Your Professional Brief

Who you are professionally: your role, your responsibilities, the decisions you make, the people you communicate with, and what success looks like in your function. Without this, Claude doesn't know who it's working for and every session starts from zero.

Document 2 — The Company Brain

What your organisation is: its positioning, its clients, its products, its current strategic priorities, and its competitive context. Stops Claude generating output that's accurate in general but wrong for your specific situation — the most common failure mode in professional AI use.

Document 3 — The Communication Style Guide

How you communicate: your voice, your preferences, your standards, and the specific patterns that make your writing recognisably yours. This is the document that makes Claude write like you rather than like a generic AI assistant. Include a sample of your own writing for best results.

WHEN TO USE

Set up once in a Claude Project — every session in that Project automatically inherits all three documents. You build this once and it pays back on every session that follows.

REMEMBER

The Context Stack is not a prompt — it is infrastructure. The professionals who build it first spend less time on every subsequent task than those who re-explain their context every session.

The EXECUTIVE Framework

A repeatable system for reports and documents that get read, acted on, and trusted

	Name / Stage / Step	What it means in practice
E	**Executive Summary**	Lead with the conclusion. The most important thing the reader needs to know comes first, before the evidence that supports it. Never make a senior reader hunt for your point.
X	**eXact Evidence**	Support every claim with specific data. Avoid vague assertions — boards and senior leaders need evidence they can probe, challenge, and use to make decisions.
E	**Explanation**	Connect the evidence to the argument explicitly. Never assume the reader will make the link. 'Revenue was down 12%' is data. 'Revenue was down 12%, driven by a contraction in the mid-market segment' is explanation.
C	**Context**	Position your analysis within the broader situation. What conditions make this finding significant? What would change the conclusion? What are the limits of what you know?
U	**Urgency**	Make clear why this matters now. What happens if the decision is delayed? What window exists — and when does it close?
T	**Takeaway**	One clear message. If the reader retains nothing else from this document, what must it be? State it explicitly — never leave this to inference.
I	**Implications**	What does this mean for what they do next? Translate analysis into action. 'This implies we should...' is more useful than 'these findings suggest that...'
V	**Visual structure**	Format for scanning, not linear reading. Use headers, white space, and hierarchy so the key points are visible at speed to someone reading for 90 seconds.
E	**Edit for the reader**	Remove everything the reader doesn't need. The final edit is not about what you want to say — it is about what they need to hear. Length is not thoroughness.

WHEN TO USE

Any report, briefing, board paper, or substantial document where the reader is senior, time-constrained, or needs to act on what you produce.

The Devil's Advocate Protocol

Five-step adversarial thinking — find and fix the weaknesses in any position before you defend it

Step 1 — State your position clearly

Write out your current position, argument, or plan in one to three sentences before you begin. Precision at this stage determines the quality of the challenge. Vague positions produce vague attacks. Be specific enough that someone could argue against it.

Step 2 — Summon the opposition

Prompt: 'You are a smart, well-informed sceptic who is trying to find the weaknesses in this position. Do not be kind. Tell me the three strongest arguments against it and the assumptions it relies on.'

Step 3 — Surface the hidden assumptions

Prompt: 'What assumptions is this position relying on that I may not have examined? Which of these is most likely to be wrong? What would have to be true for this position to fail?'

Step 4 — Restate your position

After the challenge, restate your position in writing. Has it changed? Should it? Where has it been strengthened? This step forces active integration — not passive reading of Claude's output.

Step 5 — Build the defence

Prompt: 'For each objection you raised, help me build the strongest honest response — one that acknowledges the concern directly rather than dismissing it.' An answer that engages the objection is always more credible than one that ignores it.

WHEN TO USE	Before presenting any significant position, plan, or recommendation. Before any meeting where your argument will face challenge. Before committing to a decision that is difficult to reverse.
REMEMBER	The Steel Man is the complement. Where the Devil's Advocate attacks your position, the Steel Man builds the strongest version of the opposing argument. Use both on decisions that matter.

The Three Futures Framework

Scenario planning that produces decisions, not just descriptions — three divergent futures, not best/worst/likely

Future A — The Momentum Scenario

The world where current trends continue and your existing strategy plays out as intended. Not necessarily the best case — just the continuation of current trajectory. Key question: what risks accumulate if we do nothing differently? What must we execute on for this to hold?

Future B — The Disruption Scenario

The world where something significant changes externally: a competitor makes a major move, a technology shift accelerates, a regulatory change reshapes the landscape, a macro event alters customer behaviour. Key question: what is the single most plausible disruption to our current strategy, and how do we need to be positioned to respond?

Future C — The Opportunity Scenario

The world where an unexpected opening emerges: a market shifts in your favour, a competitor stumbles, a capability you're building becomes suddenly more valuable than anticipated. Key question: if conditions for a major step-change emerged in 12–18 months, would we be positioned to take it? What would we need to do now to be ready?

WHEN TO USE	Annual strategic planning. Major investment decisions. Before committing to a direction that will be costly to reverse. When your team is anchored to a single view of what the future looks like.
REMEMBER	Scenarios that don't change your decisions aren't scenarios — they're descriptions. Push until each future implies at least one different strategic choice.

The SIGNAL Selling System

Six stages across the full deal cycle — from identifying the right prospects to learning from every close

	Name / Stage / Step	What it means in practice
S	**Surface the right prospects**	ICP Intelligence Engine: precision ideal customer profile built from actual deal data, anti-ICP definition, and a trigger event library to identify which accounts are in buying motion right now — not in three months.
I	**Investigate their world**	Pre-call research and competitive mapping: 20-minute deep context build for every significant prospect. The rep who arrives understanding the buyer's world is not just better prepared — they're in a different category.
G	**Generate personalised outreach**	Handwritten at Scale Method: the 3-Second Test, a three-step trigger-to-message workflow, and a five-touch sequence that builds across messages without repeating or escalating into pressure.
N	**Navigate objections**	Deal War Room: adversarial pre-meeting preparation, objection library builder, and stakeholder mapping that identifies who influences the decision — including the people you haven't met yet.
A	**Accelerate decisions**	30-Minute Proposal System: a five-step discovery-to-proposal chain, a pricing narrative that contextualises the number before stating it, and a pre-send stress test that finds weaknesses before the buyer does.
L	**Lock in and learn**	Post-deal debrief system: extract the real decision dynamics, the key turning points, and the one technique that would have made a specific moment go better — before the insight walks out the door.

WHEN TO USE Sales and business development professionals across the full deal cycle. Deploy S first (targeting), then G (outreach), then N (preparation) — in that sequence for fastest measurable results.

The CLEAR Operations Model

Five capabilities that transform operations professionals from bottlenecks into organisational multipliers

	Name / Stage / Step	What it means in practice
C	**Capture institutional knowledge**	Brain Dump to SOP Pipeline: turns expertise that lives in one person's head into documented, scalable process. Addresses the single most expensive form of operational risk — knowledge that leaves when people do.
L	**Legislate it into process**	Structured, living documentation: SOPs, process maps, and policy documents that stay current rather than becoming the outdated documents nobody trusts. Includes a maintenance cadence, not just creation.
E	**Execute at team scale**	Hiring Intelligence Stack: job descriptions that attract the right people and repel the wrong ones, structured interview blueprints for consistent evaluation, and onboarding documentation that builds capability faster.
A	**Audit for quality**	Performance Clarity Framework: structured review templates, development plans, and performance documentation that gives managers a system rather than a blank page for the conversations that matter most.
R	**Report with confidence**	Executive Narrative System: translates operational complexity into board-ready communication — including the most difficult situations where results are mixed, something went wrong, or the story requires stakeholders to hold uncertainty without losing confidence.

WHEN TO USE

Operations and management professionals. Deploy C first — documentation debt compounds fastest and blocks every other system.

REMEMBER

The operations professional who deploys CLEAR stops being a bottleneck and starts being a multiplier — the person who makes everyone around them more effective.

The PROFIT Intelligence Loop

Finance and accounting AI — six stages from raw data to board-ready insight and stakeholder-ready narrative

	Name / Stage / Step	What it means in practice
P	**Process raw data into structured intelligence**	Takes unstructured financial data — spreadsheets, management accounts, transaction logs — and structures it for meaningful analysis. The prerequisite to every stage that follows.
R	**Reveal the story behind the numbers**	Goes beyond what moved to what it means. Identifies the two or three patterns that matter most, not a description of every line that changed. The insight, not the data.
O	**Optimise decisions with scenario analysis**	Builds financial scenarios and stress-tests the assumptions behind them. The Three Futures Framework applied to financial planning — what changes if revenue is 15% below forecast?
F	**Flag risks early before they become problems**	Identifies risk indicators in current data — cash flow trends, covenant proximity, cost trajectories — before they escalate from warning to crisis. Proactive, not reactive.
I	**Inform stakeholders with clarity and confidence**	Translates financial complexity into stakeholder-appropriate communication. Different narratives for boards, investors, and management teams — same data, different altitude and emphasis.
T	**Track outcomes and refine the model**	Closes the loop: compares actuals to forecasts, identifies where the model was right or wrong, and refines future analysis based on evidence. The loop that makes each cycle better than the last.

WHEN TO USE Finance and accounting professionals for any analysis cycle: monthly close, board reporting, budget reviews, investment cases. Always verify all figures independently before inclusion in formal documents.

FRAMEWORK 10 OF 10

The Role Playbooks

VOICE · PEOPLE · EXPERT — three industry-specific systems for Marketing, HR, and Consulting professionals

Ch. 12–15

VOICE Content Engine			Chapter 12 · Marketing and Content
V	Voice definition	Brand Voice Lock System — teach Claude your brand voice so all content is consistent and recognisably yours.	
O	Output at scale	One-to-Eight Repurposing Engine — one core piece of content becomes eight channel-appropriate formats automatically.	
I	Inspect for humanity	AI slop detection and the human edit layer — the step that separates professional content from generic AI output.	
C	Channel adaptation	Format-specific quality standards — content calibrated to each platform, not just reformatted.	
E	Evolve with data	Content intelligence loop — uses performance data to refine what you produce next.	
PEOPLE Advantage System			Chapter 14 · HR and People Operations
P	Pipeline great candidates	Talent Magnet System — job descriptions that attract the right people and repel the wrong ones.	
E	Evaluate without bias	Structured Interview Blueprint — consistent, role-relevant evaluation across every candidate.	
O	Onboard for retention	90-Day Onboarding Accelerator — structured onboarding that builds capability and commitment simultaneously.	
P	People development at scale	Development planning and L&D frameworks for the whole team, not just high-potentials.	
L	Listen and act on signals	Engagement and retention early-warning system — identifies flight risk before it becomes attrition.	
E	Exit with intelligence	Exit Intelligence System — turns leavers into organisational learning before they walk out the door.	
EXPERT Delivery Model			Chapter 15 · Consulting and Professional Services
E	Engage the right clients	Discovery Accelerator — faster, deeper qualification and proposal development for the clients worth winning.	
X	eXecute faster with AI	Deliverable Factory — research, analysis, and documentation at professional speed without sacrificing quality.	
P	Package your knowledge	IP Packaging System — turns expertise into reusable frameworks, playbooks, and thought leadership content.	
E	Expand relationships	Account growth and relationship intelligence — identifies expansion opportunities in existing clients proactively.	
R	Retain through value	Ongoing client intelligence — stays ahead of client needs before they become dissatisfaction or attrition.	
T	Track what matters	Engagement measurement and learning — closes the loop on what's working and refines the approach.	

WHEN TO USE

Marketing, HR, and Consulting / Professional Services professionals. Turn to your specific chapter for the full system, prompts, and use cases.